The SIT was not sure if Haribabu was hired only for that assignment or whether he was part of the larger scheme of things. Their investigation into Latha Kannan and Kokila (from the photograph) had also drawn a blank. The second photo, of the 'women's enclosure', was shown to potential witnesses, but nothing really had come out. The third one, which showed the musician Shankar Ganesh speaking to a Congress politician and a real estate developer, was also of no consequence. Everyone heard him with rapt attention.

A lounge staff member informed Kaarthikeyan it was time for boarding the Colombo-bound Air India flight. The CBI chief's talk abruptly ended. He asked Anirudhya to wish them luck. He was hoping for something good to emerge from this visit to Colombo. Datta, on a lighter note, spoke in Bengali to Anirudhya, '*Dekhi Colombo giye jante pari ki na oi pyjama-punjabi pora bhadralokti ke* (Let's see if we can find out in Colombo the identity of the kurta-pyjama-clad gentleman).'

That afternoon, Chelladurai brought in information to Ragothaman that a day prior to the killing, a Sri Lankan Tamil had come from London and was staying in a five-star hotel in the city and was in touch with Shankar Ganesh. The suspect was leaving for Colombo that very night. Any Sri Lankan Tamil had become a suspect in the eyes of the investigators. Who knew if he would turn out to be the man in the white kurta pyjama? Verma took it up with Kanth and Raju. They got ready quickly. The CRPF commandos were on standby in armoured Jeeps. Everyone checked their weapons and took enough ammunition in stock. A total of sixteen officials left Malligai in Jeeps and Ambassador cars.

Raju and Kanth led the team and raided the hotel. All they found were people partying with liquor, film extras and wannabe actresses. Raju, Kanth and Verma took the 'Sri Lankan Tamil' in question aside and talked to him. He revealed he was a British citizen of Sri Lankan origin. Yes, he had come to Madras a day before the assassination to arrange a music concert in Sri Lanka and was therefore meeting artistes in Madras. The raid turned out to be a tame affair.